

Harborline Foods (Sample)

Sample · 9 employee interviews · readiness 49/100



OVERALL AI READINESS GRADE

Early

Graded across 6 areas

AI READINESS SCORECARD

Harborline Foods (Sample)

Workforce AI Fluency

50

C-

Split team: two confident daily users (Keisha 81, Priya 72), a capable middle, and four people who've never used AI at work.

Current AI Adoption

24

F

No sanctioned tool. All real usage is personal accounts — including customer pricing pasted into a free chatbot.

Opportunity & Upside

88

A-

Exceptional. ~61 hrs/week of interview-documented repetitive work: order confirmations, invoice chasing, quote writing, route notes.

Culture & Change Readiness

63

C+

7 of 9 said 'show me how' — hesitation is permission and training, not resistance. Two skeptics need proof, not pressure.

Data & Tooling

44

D

QuickBooks + a shared drive of spreadsheets. Usable for AI drafting today; order data lives in email threads.

Governance & Risk

20

F

No policy, no data rules, shadow use already live. Highest-priority fix and the cheapest one.

YOUR 90-DAY GAMEPLAN

Days 1–30

- Adopt one business-tier AI tool (data protected, no training on your data)
- Publish the one-page AI policy — end personal-account use for work
- Name Keisha AI champion; move her workflow onto the approved tool

Days 31–60

- Pilot AI-drafted order confirmations with Sam (his 90 min/day)
- AI-assisted quote drafting with Keisha + Ray — target same-day quotes
- Hands-on session for Ops, taught by Keisha on real work

Days 61–90

- Invoice-chasing drafts for Marge; delivery-note summaries for Dave
- Measure: quote turnaround, hours reclaimed, response times
- Re-assess the team and report the climb to leadership

KEY STRENGTHS

- ✓ Two proven in-house champions already producing results
- ✓ Huge, well-documented pool of repetitive work to reclaim
- ✓ People asked for training — the door is open

PRIORITY GAPS

- ! Customer pricing is leaving the company via personal AI accounts
- ! No approved tool or one-page policy
- ! Quote turnaround is losing winnable business weekly

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Harborline Foods is sitting on one of the clearest AI opportunities we've assessed: a small team drowning in exactly the kind of repetitive written work AI handles best, with two employees already proving it works — unofficially, on personal accounts, without rules. The interviews surfaced roughly 61 hours per week of documented repetitive work across nine people, a live data-handling risk (customer pricing pasted into a free chatbot), and one direct revenue leak: quotes taking two days when the customers who leave cite speed. The overall posture grades a 49 (D) — not because the team can't do this, but because nothing official exists yet. That is fixable in 90 days, and the first fixes are cheap: one approved tool, a one-page policy, and your two in-house champions teaching everyone else on real work.

DO THIS MONDAY

- Approve one business-tier AI tool and tell the team it's sanctioned — this single announcement unblocks seven of nine people and ends the pricing-data risk the same day.
- Name Keisha Adams your AI lead. She's already proven the quote workflow; a title makes her shadow skill the company standard.
- Put "quotes out same-day" on the whiteboard as the goal — every person interviewed pointed at quote speed, unprompted.

AI READINESS SNAPSHOT

This is a split team, and the split is your roadmap.

- Ahead: Keisha Adams (Inside Sales, 81/100) already drafts quotes and follow-ups with AI daily and has cut her quote-writing time roughly in half. Priya Nair (Marketing, 72/100) builds campaign copy and product descriptions with AI weekly.
- The open middle: Ray (64), Elena (58), and Sam (47) have tried AI, see the point, and asked for "someone to just show me on my actual work."
- Waiting for permission: Tom (34), Nick (39), Dave (31), and Marge (22) have never used AI at work. Not one of them pushed back on the idea — Marge asked whether it could "chase the late invoices so I don't have to write those awkward emails."

Seven of nine people asked for training in almost the same words. This is not a resistant team. It is an unled one.

WHERE THE COMPANY USES AI TODAY

Officially: nowhere. Actually: every day, in the shadows.

- Keisha runs her entire quote workflow through a personal free-tier chatbot — including pasting customer names and negotiated pricing. She flagged this herself: "I honestly don't know if I'm allowed."
- Priya uses a personal account for marketing copy.
- Everyone else assumes it's not permitted, so 61 hours a week of automatable work continues by hand.

The pattern is the classic one: your most valuable AI behavior is already happening, but it's unprotected, unshared, and invisible to leadership.

WHERE WORK GETS STUCK

The interviews mapped four handoffs where Harborline's speed actually dies — and three of the four are AI-compressible:

- Quotes wait on pricing. Keisha and Ray wait up to a day for lane pricing from ops before a quote can go out. AI-drafted pricing from your rate sheet, human-verified, turns a day into an hour. This is the revenue handoff.
- Customers wait on status. Sam types each update from scratch after digging through email threads — customers feel that lag as silence. Drafted updates turn 2.5 minutes into 20 seconds.
- Leadership waits on Friday. Dana's leadership recap arrives end-of-week because compiling it takes 45 minutes a day of note-gathering. Summarized driver notes make it a daily 5-minute review.
- Everyone waits on Marge's month-end. Invoice chasing bunches into a dreaded week. Drafted reminders spread it into a daily 10-minute habit — and cash arrives sooner.

TOP AI OPPORTUNITIES

1. Same-day quotes

- The opportunity: AI-drafted quotes from your price sheet, reviewed and sent by Keisha and Ray the same morning they arrive.
- The benefit: Ray and Elena both cited losing winnable orders to a 2-day turnaround while competitors answer in hours.

- First step: give Keisha's existing workflow an approved home and a price-sheet template.

2. Order confirmations and shipping updates

- The opportunity: Sam writes ~35 confirmation and status emails a day, each "basically the same three sentences."
- The benefit: about 90 minutes of his day back for the escalations that actually need a human.
- First step: collect his ten most-used emails as templates.

3. Invoice chasing

- The opportunity: Marge hand-writes every overdue-invoice reminder and dreads the tone. AI drafts firm-but-warm reminders in seconds; she reviews and sends.
- The benefit: faster collections and a task she hates removed. She asked for exactly this in her interview.
- First step: three reminder templates (gentle, firm, final) built from her best past emails.

4. Route and delivery notes

- The opportunity: Dave compiles driver notes and delivery exceptions into a morning summary by hand.
- The benefit: a 45-minute daily task becomes a 5-minute review.
- First step: standardize the driver note format so AI can summarize it reliably.

5. Product descriptions and promos

- The opportunity: Priya's campaign and catalog work, moved from her personal account to the approved tool and shared as team templates.
- The benefit: her proven workflow becomes company capability instead of personal heroics.
- First step: a shared prompt library seeded with her ten best prompts.

ESTIMATED IMPACT

Conservative arithmetic from what your people described, assuming the 90-day roadmap:

- Order confirmations (Sam): 35 emails/day × ~2.5 min ≈ 7 hrs/week
- Quote drafting (Keisha + Ray): 12 quotes/week × ~50 min → ~15 min ≈ 7 hrs/week
- Invoice reminders (Marge): ~4 hrs/week of drafting → ~1 hr of review ≈ 3 hrs/week
- Delivery summaries (Dave): 45 min/day ≈ 3.5 hrs/week
- Marketing production (Priya): ≈ 4 hrs/week already demonstrated on her own

- Everything else surfaced (meeting recaps, catalog updates, supplier emails): $\approx$ 5–8 hrs/week

Rollup: roughly 29–32 reclaimed hours per week across nine people — the equivalent of adding three-plus working days of capacity every week, or most of a full-time hire, without hiring. Separately, the quote-speed fix touches revenue directly: Elena estimates two winnable orders a week currently die in the 2-day turnaround. Even one saved order per week pays for this program many times over.

These are floor numbers, not ceilings — they assume no new automation, only drafting assistance on work your team already described.

RISKS AND GOVERNANCE

- Live now — data leaving the building: customer names and negotiated pricing are being pasted into a free personal chatbot. Not malice; the absence of an approved alternative. A business-tier tool and a one-page policy end this in week one.
- Accuracy: quotes and invoices carry numbers. The rule to institute: AI drafts, a human verifies every number before send. Marge and Sam both instinctively proposed this themselves — codify it.
- Over-reliance: keep humans on judgment calls — Ray's negotiations, Sam's angry-customer escalations. Your people already drew these lines correctly in their interviews.
- Shadow use: already present. The fix is a sanctioned better option, not a ban — a ban would simply push it further underground and lose you your champions.

TRAINING AND ENABLEMENT PLAN

- Champions: Keisha (formally name her; her quote workflow is your proof of concept) with Priya as second. Champion-taught sessions beat vendor webinars — your skeptics said so explicitly ("not another webinar," Tom).
- The open middle (Ray, Elena, Sam): one hands-on hour each on their own real tasks. They'll carry themselves after that.
- The hesitant four (Tom, Nick, Dave, Marge): pair each with a champion for one task they hate. Marge's invoice reminders are the ideal first win — high dread, low risk, instant payoff.

A 90-DAY ROADMAP

Month 1 — Sanction and secure: approve one business-tier tool; publish the one-page policy;

move Keisha's and Priya's workflows onto it; name champions.

Month 2 — Pilot the money-makers: same-day quotes (Keisha + Ray), order confirmations (Sam), champion-led training for Ops.

Month 3 — Spread and measure: invoice reminders (Marge), delivery summaries (Dave), shared prompt library, and a re-assessment to show leadership the climb.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE IN 6 MONTHS

You will know this worked when:

- Quotes go out the same morning they arrive — and you stop hearing "we went with someone faster."
- Sam's status updates are drafted, reviewed, and sent — not typed — and his afternoons go to the escalations that need him.
- Marge's invoice reminders leave daily without dread, and receivables stop bunching at month-end.
- Customer pricing never touches a personal account — everything runs through the approved tool under your one-page policy.
- The whole team has practiced on their own real work, taught by your own champions.
- Team readiness has climbed from 49 toward 70 — measured, not guessed, at your next two assessments.

METRICS TO TRACK

- Quote turnaround: ~2 days → same day
- Status-email time (Sam): ~90 min/day → under 15 min/day
- Days sales outstanding: month-end bunching → steady weekly collections
- Sanctioned AI use: 0 of 9 on an approved tool → 9 of 9
- Team readiness score: 49 (D) → 70 (B-), verified at assessments 2 and 3
- Hours reclaimed: 0 → ~30/week across the team

RECOMMENDED TOOLS

- A business-tier AI assistant (e.g. ChatGPT Team or Claude Team) — drafting with a data agreement, so nothing trains on your customers.

- AI drafting inside your email (Microsoft Copilot or Gemini for Workspace) — meets Sam and Marge where they already work.
- A shared prompt library (a simple doc to start) — turns Keisha's and Priya's private skill into company capability.

READINESS BY DEPARTMENT

- Sales — your engine. Keisha (81) and Ray (64) with the clearest revenue case. Lean on: Keisha.
- Operations — biggest hour pool, most hesitant people (Tom 34, Nick 39, Dave 31). Champion-taught, task-first training. Lean on: Tom once converted — the team follows him.
- Finance — Marge (22) is your lowest score and your easiest win. One template session changes her month.
- Marketing — Priya (72) is ready today; she just needs the approved tool.

INDIVIDUAL PROFILES

Keisha Adams

Inside Sales, 81/100 — your most advanced user and the blueprint. Already halved her quote-writing time on a personal account. Recommendation: name her AI champion, move her to the approved tool immediately, and have her teach the quote workflow to Ray in week one.

Marge Kowalski

Bookkeeper, 22/100 — lowest score, best first win. Dreads writing overdue-invoice emails and asked, unprompted, whether AI could help with exactly that. Recommendation: one 30-minute session building her three reminder templates; verify-every-number rule from day one.

Tom Brennan

Operations Manager, 34/100 — the culture key. Skeptical of "another webinar," respected by the warehouse team; where Tom goes, Ops follows. Recommendation: skip the pitch — have Keisha solve one real Tom-task in front of him.

Sam Osei

Customer Service, 47/100 — 35 near-identical emails a day and he knows it. Open, just unled. Recommendation: template his top ten emails; measure the 90 minutes he gets back and tell the team.

(Your report includes a profile like this for every person interviewed.)

Fees, tools, and best practices change quickly — revisit tool choices each quarter and confirm data-handling terms directly with vendors.